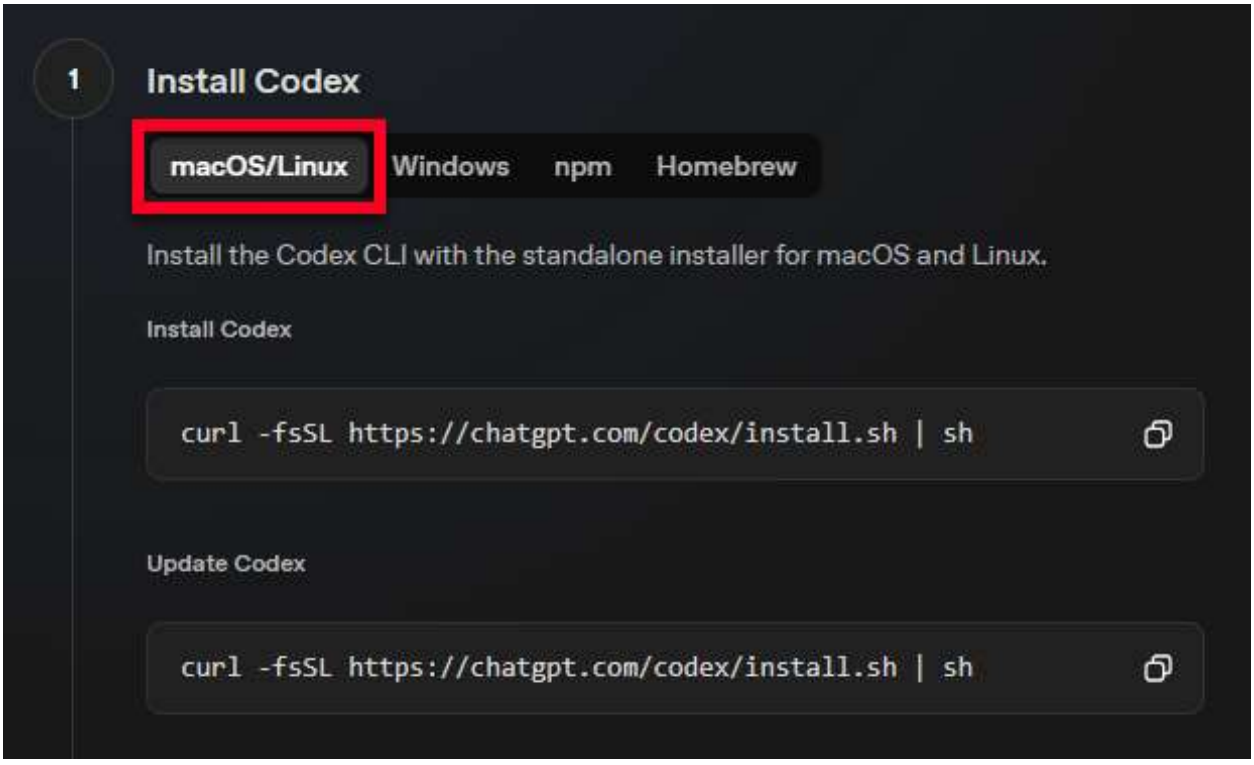
Installing Codex

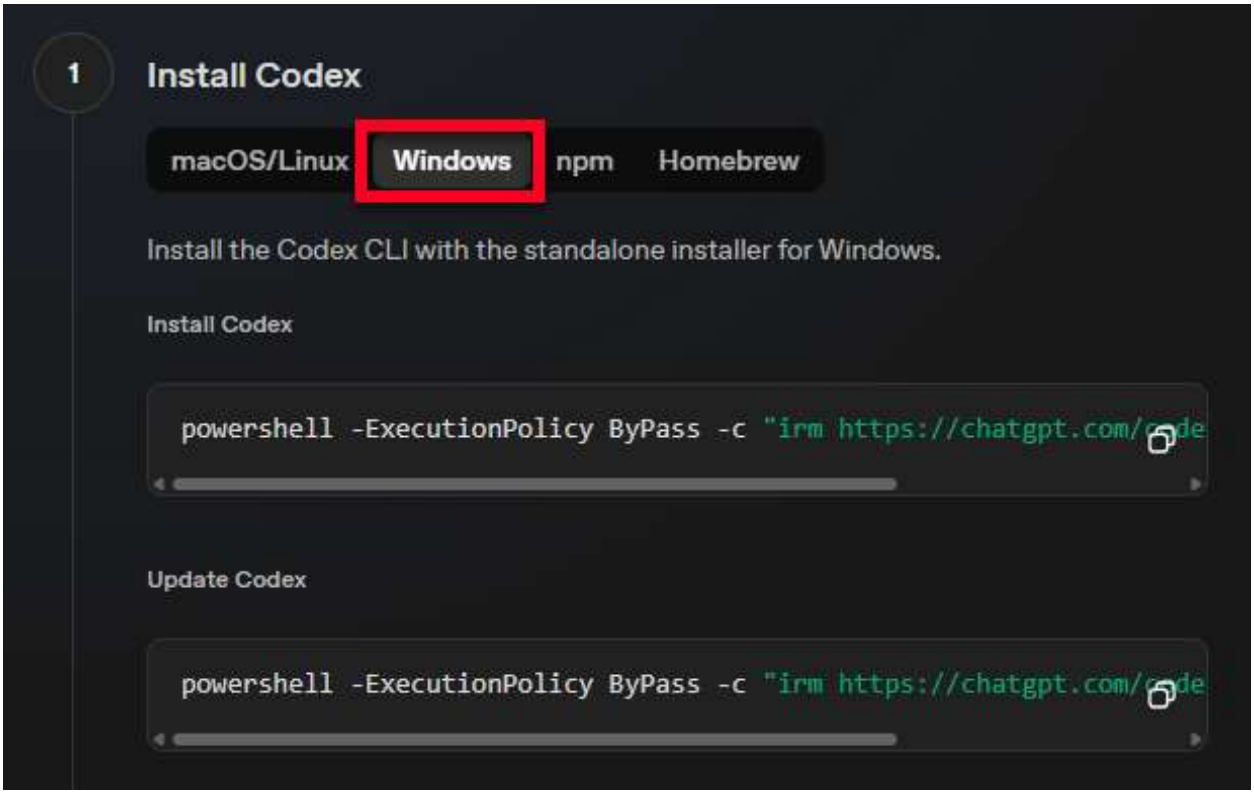
Before we start using Codex inside real projects, we need to make sure our computer has the right tools installed.

- Key concept:**Key update.** Node.js is not needed for the recommended standalone Codex installer, but it is needed to run the React project files later in the course.

Recommended Installation

For most learners, the recommended path is the standalone installer. The latest official instructions are available in the Codex CLI documentation at https://learn.chatgpt.com/docs/codex/cli. Open a terminal and run the command for your operating system.





macOS, Linux, WSL

Run curl -fsSL https://chatgpt.com/codex/install.sh | sh in your terminal.

Windows Power

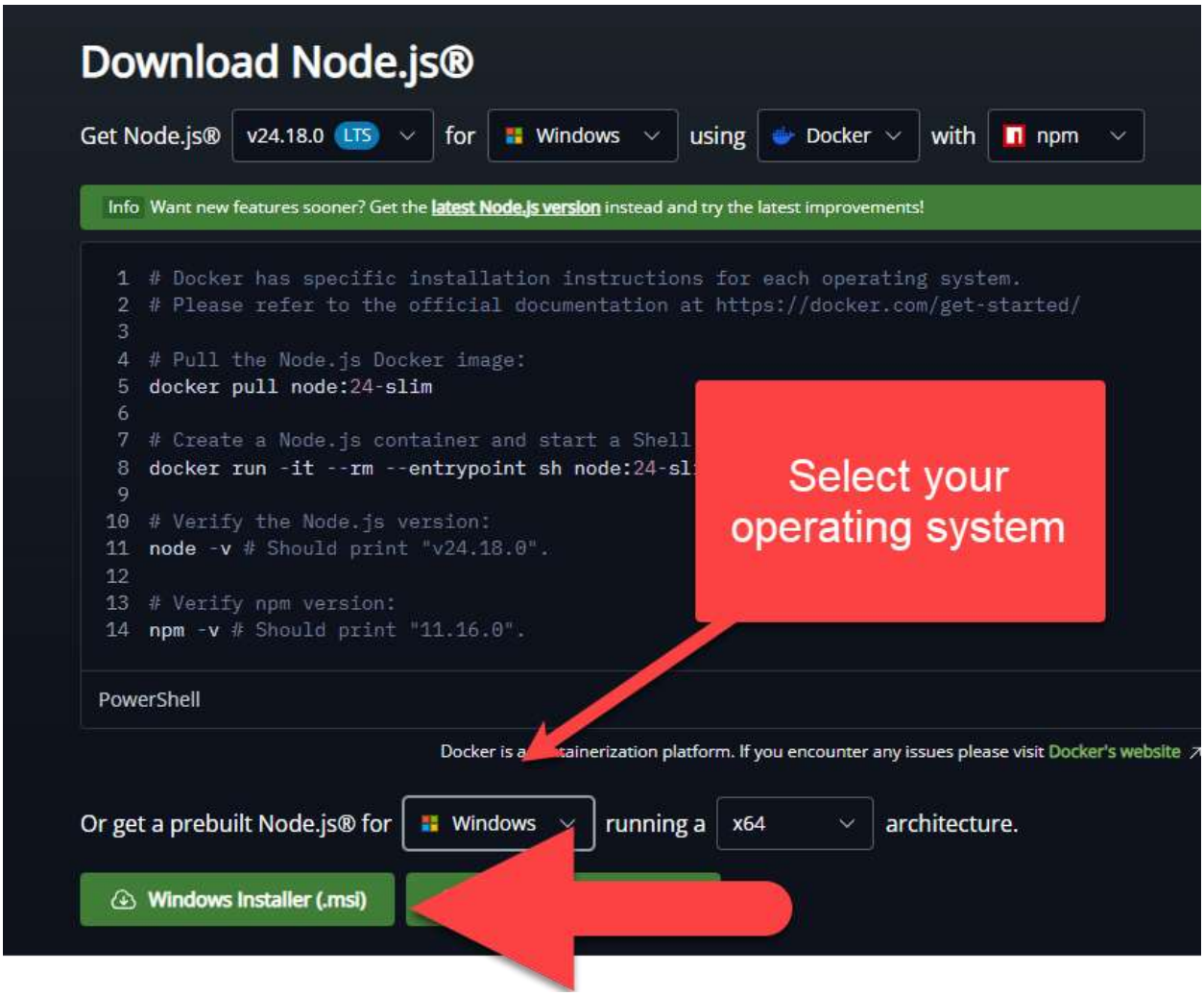
Run powershell -ExecutionPolicy ByPass -c "irm https://chatgpt.com/codex/install.ps1 | iex" in PowerShell.

ShellOther installers

You may also see installation options for Homebrew or npm. These are alternative paths, but the standalone installer is the simplest option to start with.

Install Node.js

Node.js lets your computer run the React project files used in this course. Go to https://nodejs.org/download and select your operating system. Then choose the prebuilt installer for your platform.



Alternative Codex Installation

This is NOT needed if you already installed Codex using the standalone installer presented earlier. If you do choose the npm installation method for Codex, you can run this command:

npm install -g @openai/codex

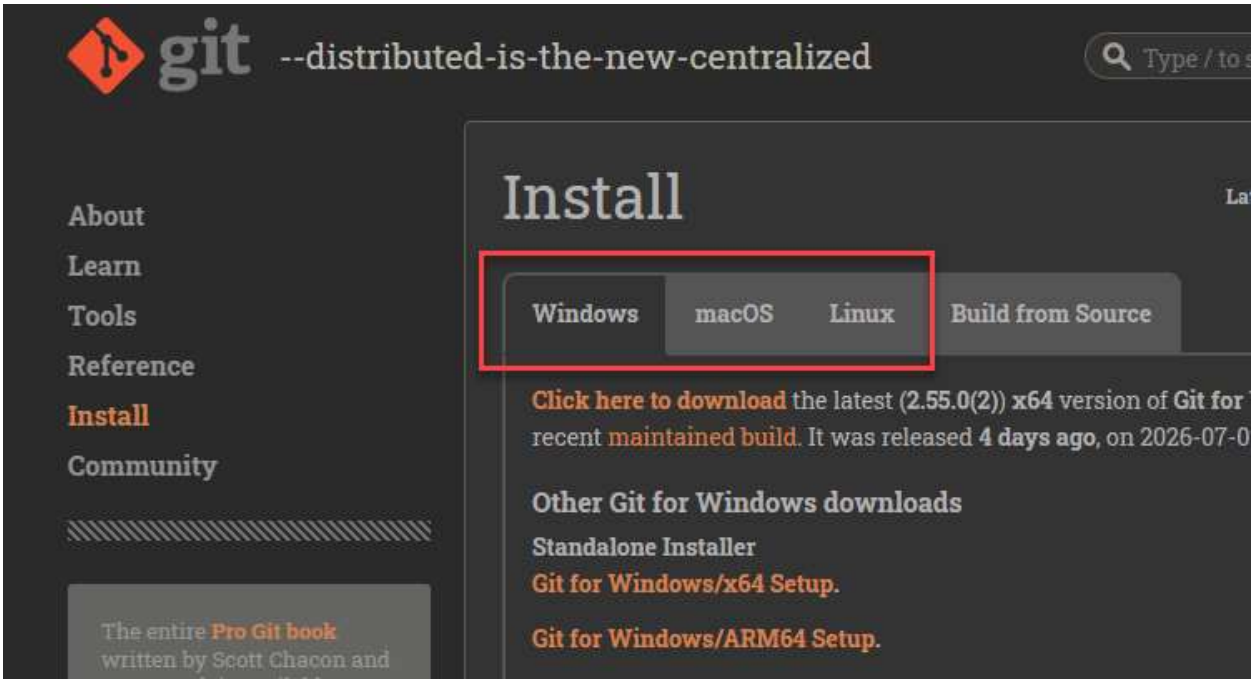
- Do:
- Use the standalone Codex installer if you want the simplest setup path.
- Install Node.js so you can run the course project files locally.

Install Git

- Note:**What is Git?** Git is a version control tool that tracks changes in a project over time.

- Key concept:**Why is it important?** Git gives us a safety net when working with code. We can review what changed, save good versions of our work, and roll back changes if needed.

Go to https://git-scm.com/downloads and choose your operating system. The site will show the installer or installation instructions that match your computer.



Once Git is installed, your computer will be ready to work with repositories and version-controlled projects.

Ready to continue

In the next lesson, we will continue setting up Codex and cover the important setup details that help you use it effectively inside real projects.